Oregon Department of Human Services

Licensed Child Caring Agency Unannounced Site Visit Report
Therapeutic Board Schools

Licensee: JBARJ Youth Services – The Academy at Sisters
Executive Director: Stephanie Alvstad
Program Director: Melinda Hare
Board Chairperson: Jeannette McKenzie
Date of Unannounced: June 12th, 2023
Licensing Coordinator: Ed Wyller
Other Regulatory or Accrediting Agencies: National Association of Therapeutic Schools Programs, Inc (NATSAP), Council on Accreditation, Cognia, and Sevis approved

Purpose: Per OAR 419-400-0240 (1)(b) Children's Care Licensing is required to perform at least one unannounced site visit a year where children in care reside.

Previous Findings Unannounced Site Visit 11/01/2022 – 11/02/2022	Repeat Findings Further Action Needed	Comments
Physical Plant 413-215-0616(2)(a) &(c) Buildings are smoke free, clean and in good repair Repeated Finding: Bathroom in modular is very slow to drain, program reports a work order will be made for that to be addressed. At time of visit the modular is not being used as all students are in the main building for sleeping arrangements.	**Yes☐ No✓**	• Entire modular building has been remodeled with a newly remodeled bathroom. Sink now functions properly and one student is using the modular building now. In Compliance.

Consents 413-215-0676(1) (e) To allow access as required in ORS418.305, OAR413-215-0091 & 0101 Consents were missing to allow access as required in ORS418.305, OAR413-215-0091 & 0101 Repeated Finding: The Academy student charts were missing the consents to allow access as defined in 413-215-0091 and 0101.	**Yes☐ No✓**	• I verified that current student charts had this consent completed. Program has adopted the use of DocuSign which is very convenient for having parents sign forms when students are coming from other States to the Academy. (In Compliance)
Additional Findings Related to SB 710: 413-215-0077 (11)(e): Each child agency shall provide notice regarding how to access the quarterly reports to the parents or guardians of children in care in the program. The child caring agency shall provide the notice upon the child in care's admission and at least two times each year thereafter. Repeated Finding: The academy student charts did not have documentation indicating that the info required by 413-215-0077 (11) (e) had been provided at the time of admissions. JBARJ Agency has developed the required forms; however, they have not been implemented at The Academy.	**Yes☐ No✓**	• I verified that student records contain the necessary SB 710 requirements. I found that program has adopted the use of DocuSign for signing consents and authorizations. (In Compliance)
Additional Findings Related to SB 710: 413-215-0078 (1) Each child in care receiving services from a child caring agency must be given the following: (a) Instruction regarding how a child in care may report suspected inappropriate use of restraint or seclusion. (b) Assurance that the child in care will not experience retaliation for reporting suspected inappropriate uses of restraint or involuntary seclusion.	**Yes☐ No✓**	• I verified that student records contain the necessary SB 710 requirements. I found that program has adopted the use of DocuSign for signing consents and authorizations. (In Compliance)

(c) The telephone number for the toll-free child abuse hotline described in ORS 417.805 and the telephone numbers and electronic mail addresses for the program's licensing agency, the child in care's caseworker, and attorney, the child in care's court appointed special advocate and Disability Rights Oregon. Repeated Finding: The Academy student charts did not have documentation indicating the information required by 413-215-0078 (1) had been given to youth in care. JBARJ Agency has developed the required forms; however, they have not been implemented at The Academy.		

New Findings from Site Visit	Comments
N/A	Good work!!

Interview Summary
I interviewed two students separately outside by the picnic tables adjacent to the main building. Both students reported feeling safe at The Academy. On a scale from 0-10 (0=worst school and 10=best school) they reported The Academy to be a 7, and 8. Students reported having enough to eat and that the last Chef was amazing. Youth reported most recent chef made authentic tacos, fillet minion. This chef has recently left, and program is looking for a new chef. Both students reported food is currently fine and that program still makes necessary dietary accommodations for students such as tailoring food for those with allergies, celiac disease, and diabetes. Student's reported learning how to manage anger, coping skills, and how to say no. The other student reported, "learned so much and has changed for the better." One student reported EMDR (Eye Movement Desensitization Therapy) to be very helpful for her. For fun students reported playing cards, reading, visiting the horses, movies, walks, and on-site arts and crafts. For off-site recreation students reported going bowling, thrifting, and visiting the crystal store. Going hiking and visiting local lakes were reported as well. Both students reported going on two big trips. In August program goes Whitewater rafting. This past Spring Break program visited Catalina Island for a Science filled spring break. The semester students were in Oceanography class and then had hands on learning and activities such as night snorkeling while ocean had bioluminescent tides. Students reported teachers to be great at The Academy School. Students reported having both treatment phone calls and personal phone calls with family. Both spoke about visits with family. Each student was asked if, given a magic wand that could improve the program, what would they do. One student reported having central air conditioning instead of window air conditioners and swamp coolers would be preferable. Another suggestion was to add more staff. The other student reported wanting to improve staff to accept feedback from students, more snacks, and moving wake up time form 5:45am to 6am.

I spoke with various staff. It was reported the program continues to improve. Staffing was reported to be good. Being accredited with COA (Council on Accreditation) has been very helpful in program improvement. The Academy reported when student transports are used, they use Right Direction. It was reported Right Direction does a good job. Educational consultants are used for interventions when needed. The Academy is going to do a summer school program for summertime, and students and teachers are excited about this curriculum.

Observations
When I arrived, students were doing chores, cleaning up after lunch and getting ready for school. After chores students were preparing for the end of year presentations for school. Interactions between students and staff were observed to be both supportive and appropriate. I observed the facility to be orderly and clean. The Kitchen remodel has been completed with student self-serve salad bar and snack area. Intake office has been repainted and new flooring installed, offering a bright welcoming environment. I observed admissions coordinator speaking with a student that will be arriving in the late-night hours discussing how admission / intake process will proceed. This student is transitioning from a wilderness program in another state. In September youth bedrooms will have carpet removed and new flooring will be installed. The transition modular has been completely remodeled and at this time one student occupies the space.

Corrective Actions and Timeframes:

All previous findings have been addressed and no new findings were identified. Good work!

Licensing Coordinator's Signature: _____ Date: 7/05/2023

Manager Review: _____ Date: 6-28-2023